

Harrisia portoricensis

Higo Chumbo

Family (Cactaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Threatened)

Description

Higo chumbo is a fruit-bearing cactus, primarily from the species *Opuntia ficus-indica*, though other species like *Harrisia portoricensis* are also referred to by the same name in some regions. It is characterized by its flat, paddle-like pads (cladodes) covered in spines and its sweet, colorful fruit.



Location/Habitat

The populations on Mona and Monito islands have not changed significantly since the species was listed. The Desecheo NWR population is increasing after the eradication of rats, goats and monkeys. The latest studies indicate that the population size of the species is approximately 59,000 individuals in Mona Island; 136 adult individuals in Monito Island; and 72 individuals in Desecheo NWR.

Sources: <https://www.fws.gov/species/search>

<https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/report/species-listings-by-state-totals?statusCategory=Listed>
<https://efotg.sc.egov.usda.gov/#/state/CR/documents/section=4&folder=-3>